eComplete Commerce website benchmark

ecompletecommerce.com: current state, measured against published standards, with a correction plan

Static review, 30 October 2026

Executive summary

Overall rating

Needs correction

4 red · 3 amber · 2 unverified

1. The brand is out of date.

Smollan made the rename official on 1 Sep 2026. The site still runs as eComplete and calls the move a transition.

2. Navigation fails as a system.

26 header and footer links point to /about, so Blog, Careers and Privacy are unreachable as labelled.

3. Trust and privacy are the biggest risks.

Unsourced growth claims, and a lead form with no visible privacy notice.

Sources: homepage and contact page fetch (30 Oct 2026); Smollan and trade press on the 1 Sep 2026 rename.

Scorecard against standards

Area	Rating	Evidence
Brand and domain	**Red**	Smollan rename live 1 Sep; site still says transition
Navigation	**Red**	Header and footer links all point to /about
Trust and proof	**Red**	Growth and revenue claims lack timeframe and method
Privacy (POPIA)	**Red**	Form and newsletter lack visible notice or consent
Accessibility	**Amber**	Empty alt text; repeated headings; contrast untested
SEO foundations	**Amber**	Meta tags present; blog dead-ends; duplicate H1
Conversion path	**Amber**	One 7-field form; no booking or phone route
Performance and security	**Unverified**	No CWV field data, Lighthouse or header check run

Standards: Core Web Vitals (LCP ≤2.5s, INP ≤200ms, CLS ≤0.1 at p75), WCAG 2.2 AA, POPIA, SEO fundamentals.

Three things visitors hit first

26

header and footer links point to /about, not the page they name

2

H1 tags on the homepage; sections repeat 2 to 3 times in markup

1 Sep

2026: Smollan rename went live; the site still says transition

- Blog, Careers and Privacy & Data are dead ends. Careers affects recruitment; Privacy affects POPIA posture.
- Repeated blocks (stats, testimonials, FAQ, CTA) are probably responsive duplicates. Confirm they are hidden from assistive tech.
- FAQ questions show with no visible answers in the extracted page. Confirm the accordion works.

Counts from homepage markup. Duplicate and FAQ behaviour to be confirmed in a rendered browser.

Trust, privacy and accessibility gaps

Proof claims need sources

- $350M+ revenue and 150+ stores: no date range or definition
- Case studies show 65–75% organic growth and 75–88% revenue growth, with no baseline or period
- +27% team capacity and +34% client lifetime value: no method
- Reebok 103% quote: needs client sign-off and underlying data

Privacy and accessibility

- Contact form collects name, email, country, company and monthly online revenue, with no visible privacy notice or consent wording (POPIA s18)
- Newsletter sign-up has no visible opt-in wording (POPIA s69, electronic direct marketing)
- Images carry empty alt text in markup, so case-study and client-logo images convey nothing to screen readers
- Verify on the live form before raising with legal

POPIA references are for orientation; confirm with counsel. Live form behaviour was not tested.

Correction plan

Weeks 0–2: stop the damage

- Fix header and footer routes
- Replace "transition" banner with a dated Smollan notice
- Add privacy notice and consent to form and newsletter
- Remove or source unverified claims

Weeks 3–8: rebuild trust

- Case-study pages with method, period and sign-off
- Working Blog and Careers pages
- Split form: quick enquiry plus booking link
- Install analytics, Search Console and CWV tracking

Months 3–6: consolidate

- 301 map to the Smollan domain
- Search Console change-of-address
- Set a legacy sunset date
- A/B test CTA and form length

Effort and ownership to be sized with the web and SEO owners.

Decisions and limits

Decisions I would make

1. Consolidate onto the Smollan domain with 301s rather than run two live sites. Dual brands dilute both.
2. Set a 90-day sunset for ecompletecommerce.com.
3. Pause new lead capture until the privacy notice is live.

Not run here (slides 8–10)

- Crawl of all URLs: not run
- Core Web Vitals, headers and TLS: not run, sandbox has no access
- Rendered accessibility and contrast: not run
- Live form test and consent: not run
- Peer benchmark: method defined, not run

Gaps closed in this pass

Item	Result	Status
Site measurement	Sandbox cannot resolve the domain; no timing, header or TLS data	**Not measured**
Internal pages	About, Solutions, Capabilities, Worldwide, Blog, Careers and Privacy are not in search results, so cannot be fetched	**Not reviewed**
Smollan rename	Confirmed: eComplete Commerce became Smollan Digital Commerce on 1 Sep 2026	**Closed**
Domain	Third-party listing shows ecomplete.co.za; redirect status unknown	**Partly**
Shopify presence	Listed in the Shopify partner directory, Cape Town	**Closed**
Peer benchmark	Candidate peers identified; their pages not reviewed	**Not done**

Method limit: the fetch tool only opens URLs that appear in earlier search or fetch results.

Coverage register (1 of 2): measure

Check	Method (run from a networked machine)	Pass threshold
Full crawl	Screaming Frog crawl of all URLs; export broken links, orphans and indexability	Zero broken internal links; every key page indexable
Core Web Vitals	PageSpeed Insights on home, category, product and contact; CrUX in Search Console	LCP ≤2.5s, INP ≤200ms, CLS ≤0.1 at p75, mobile and desktop
Security headers and TLS	securityheaders.com and SSL Labs test	Grade A or better; HSTS and CSP present; TLS 1.2+ only
Rendered accessibility	axe DevTools on five templates; keyboard-only and screen reader pass	Zero critical axe issues; WCAG 2.2 AA contrast met

Thresholds: web.dev Core Web Vitals; WCAG 2.2 AA; POPIA s18 and s69 (confirm with counsel).

Coverage register (2 of 2): verify

Check	Method (run from a networked machine)	Pass threshold
FAQ and hidden sections	Open each in a browser; inspect the DOM for duplicates and aria-hidden	FAQ answers visible; duplicates hidden from assistive tech
Live form and consent	Test submission with a test account; inspect network calls and consent wording	Notice and unticked consent before submit; no data sent before consent
Scripts, cookies, structured data	Clean browser profile; Rich Results Test; check robots.txt and sitemap.xml	Tags wait for consent; valid schema; sitemap lists all indexable pages
Peer benchmark	Same checks on 2–3 comparable agencies, chosen with the business	Gap score documented for each check

Run order: crawl and CWV first, then accessibility and form tests, then peer benchmark.

Remediation timeline with gates



Rule: no phase starts until the previous gate passes. Final exit: 301s cover 100% of URLs and Search Console shows no new errors.

Timeline assumes approval this week. Durations to be sized with the web and SEO owners.